

The Role of the Mentor, PCM and Link Tutor in your Training.



Academic Reading

Black-Hawkins K., Meaker, M., Dudley, P. and Swaffieldeds, S. *The Role of Trainee, Mentor and Tutor* from Reflective Teaching in Schools (2014) Pollard and Pollard

Caires S., Almeida, L. and Vieira, D. (2012) 'Becoming a teacher: student teachers' experiences and perceptions about teaching practice', *European Journal of Teacher Education*, vol. 35, no. 2, pp. 163–78.

Daloz, L. (1986) *Effective teaching and Mentoring*, San Francisco, Jossey Bass.

Hobson, A., Ashby, P., Maldarez, A and Tomlinson, D. (2009) Mentoring Beginning Teachers: What We Know and What We Don't *Teacher and Teaching Education Journal*

What role will the mentor have in your training?

- Draw an image

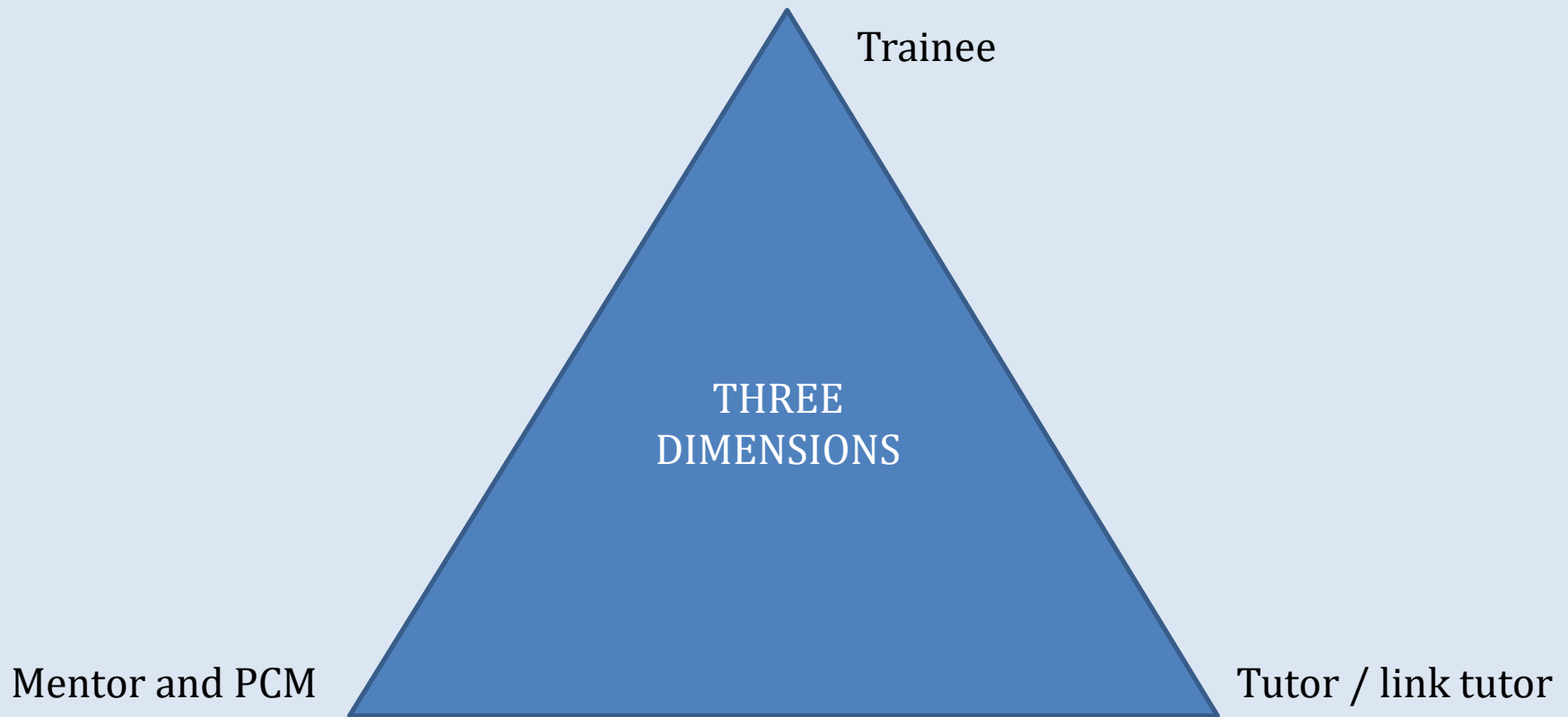


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Learning intentions:

- to demonstrate the role the PCM plays in your training
- to show the role the mentor plays in your training
- to consider how the roles of the mentor and link tutor complement each other
- to understand your role and responsibilities in your training
- to learn how to manage the relationship with a mentor

The relationship between trainee, mentor and university tutor



Session focus:

- What is the role of the PCM?
- What is the role of your mentor?
- What are your responsibilities to the PCM and mentor?
 - How do you work collaboratively with your mentor?
- What difficulties could you encounter with a mentor?
- How do you as a trainee overcome these issues or difficulties?
- How does the role of the mentor change as you progress through your PGCE?

The Professional Co-Ordinating Mentor (PCM)

- Co-ordinates all aspects of training such as professional studies including safeguarding
- Responsible for monitoring quality of training within the school and supporting all mentors
- Co-ordinates and add comments to the trainee's progress and assessment records
- Observes the trainee teaching once during the teaching phase
- Manage school-based aspects of support and Call for Additional Support with the University through contact with link tutors

What helps a PCM to help you ?

The first day –

- be punctual and appropriately dressed
- be prepared – with DBS and anything else you have been asked to bring

On placement –

- be professional
- contribute to Professional Studies sessions
- be organised with deadlines and documentation needed for end of placement progress or assessment reports (give them ample time to complete their part in the process)

See the separate ppt from Mary Nkune for a more in-depth overview of these points. The presentation also includes details of the CPD package sent to mentors as part of St Mary's support and provision for mentors in our partnership.

The Mentor

- main support and guidance for all aspects of trainees' development (SMU guidance)
- first port of call in addressing issues
- liaising with university tutor and PCM to review progress against the CCF or Teachers' Standards and with SMU for development and training
- 2 formal observations per week
- completes the Progress Records (FDN and DEV phases of teaching) and the Assessment Profile (CON phase of teaching)
- helps trainee with reviewing Progress presentations before submission

Sampson and Yeomans (1994)

suggest that the role of the mentor has three dimensions.

1. **structural** – working across the school as planner, organizer, negotiator, inductor for the student placement;
2. **supportive** – working with the student as host, friend and counsellor
3. **professional** – working with the student as trainer, educator and assessor

Extract taken from: Reflective Teaching in Schools

Ref: Pollard, A., Black-Hawkins, K. & Cliff Hodges, G. (2014), *Reflective Teaching in Schools*, Bloomsbury Publishing, London

The dynamics of the mentor role – providing support and challenge

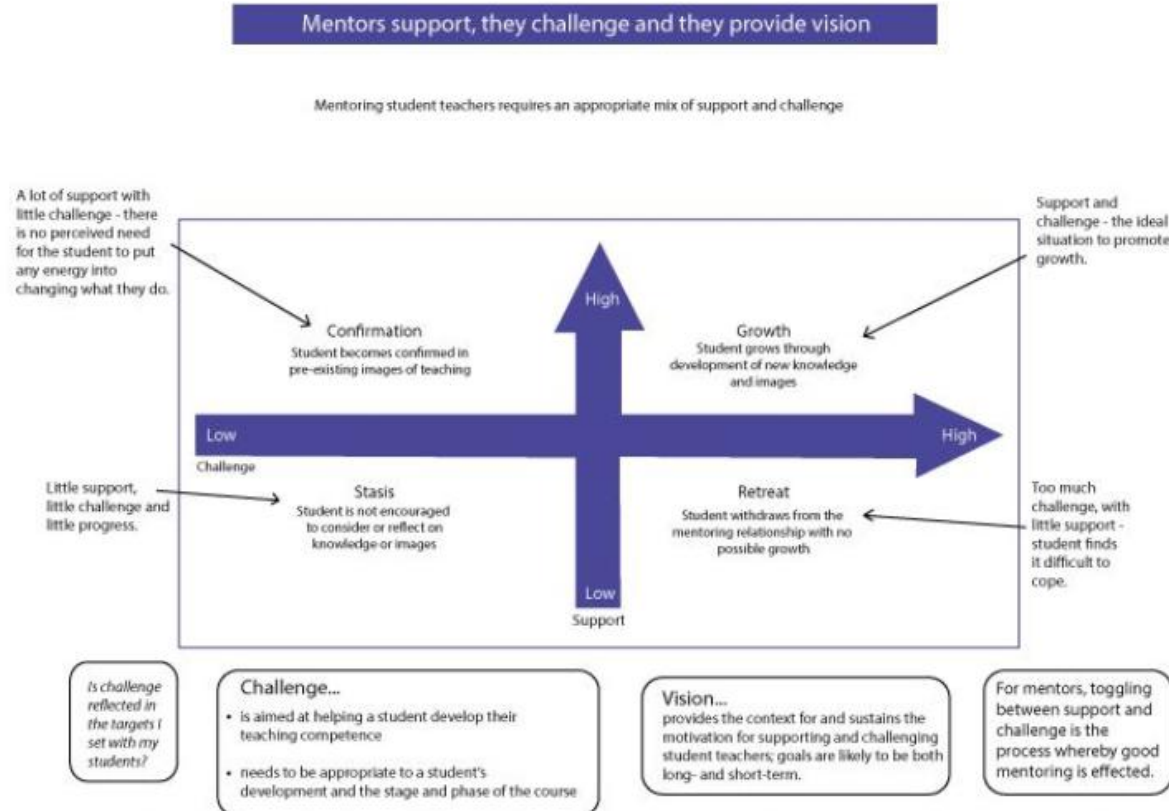


Figure 1 This diagram demonstrates pictorially the balancing dynamics of the mentor role, of providing both support and challenge to the student teacher. (Source: adapted from Martin (1996), Daloz (1986))

The dynamics of the mentor role – providing support and challenge

Support

Being the critical professional friend – through effective feedback and professional dialogue

Challenge

Providing opportunities and helping a student/trainee develop their teaching competence – through classes, targets

Vision

Provides the context for the support and challenge in the short term and long term

What helps a mentor to help you ?

- come on time and prepared for the mentor session and make notes
- have reflected and acted on the last meeting
- be organised and sort your teaching/ school placement file
- have your lesson plans and formal observations
- know your own targets and be able to discuss your lesson and progress
- be proactive not pushy in the department
- **give your lesson plans in on time!**



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Trainee's responsibility

- personal and professional conduct e.g. adhere to all school policies
- organisation
- attendance and punctuality to mentor meetings, raising concerns
- 100% attendance at school and university sessions.

Unavoidable absences - inform school PCM and mentor and University admin (Abyasa) and subject tutor

Activity (linked to session focus):

The following activity is designed for you and your peers to discuss the questions posed above by considering a range of scenarios, some of which are based on real life situations

Activity

Part 1 - In your working groups read the scenarios on the card sheets provided. Each has a scenario about a trainee and mentor. With you peers discuss the issue presented – and decide if it is problematic and if so, the solutions to overcome it.

Part 2 - Then place it on the mentor chart under one of the quarters on the chart of the Dynamics of the Mentor Role: Confirmation, Growth, Stasis, Retreat. Be able to explain your decision on where you have placed it.

University tutor/ link tutor

Sampson and Yeomans (1994)

three dimensions

1. **structural** - would often have established relationships with 'link' or 'partnership' schools, so that the placement could be negotiated smoothly.
2. **supportive** – facilitate and support the relationship between the student and mentor as it develops, so that the potential benefits of that learning relationship are nurtured
3. **professional** - the tutor contributes to the educational process by offering comparative experience and knowledge from reading and research. In the assessment phase he or she is able to draw on comparative judgement and may be able to enhance consistency of judgement across schools

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- Virtual visits – initial school visit (online) one per school placement
 - In person visits – one per teaching phase
 - Assess progress with mentor and possibly PCM
 - Liaise with mentor especially if issues about trainee progress
 - Offer subject specific advice
 - Quality assure the mentor, school provision, training

Vic Crooks blog Uni of Nottingham

University observation visits are seen as a **collaborative** endeavour between the tutor and mentor, supporting the student with the **different perspectives** of **teacher educators** working in **mutual partnership**. Tutor visits are portrayed to the student as a '**normal**' part of the **constructive learning process**; the student is encouraged to plan and prepare as usual, and the mentor acts as a 'sounding board' for any ideas. They are encouraged to take risks and be inventive but only to maximise the value of the feedback opportunity.

‘Singing From the Same Hymn Sheet’

‘These findings support previous research by Burn et al (2007, 430) demonstrating the ‘distinctive and complementary’ nature of the two roles, with USTs perceived as providing critical distance from specific school contexts through ‘academic’ or propositional knowledge about effective teaching practices. SBM perceptions suggest that they see the USTs as being able to deploy practice knowledge, evidence from research and developmental thinking to enable trainees to develop as professionals who take an open, positively critical and criterion-based approach to all recommendations for practice.’

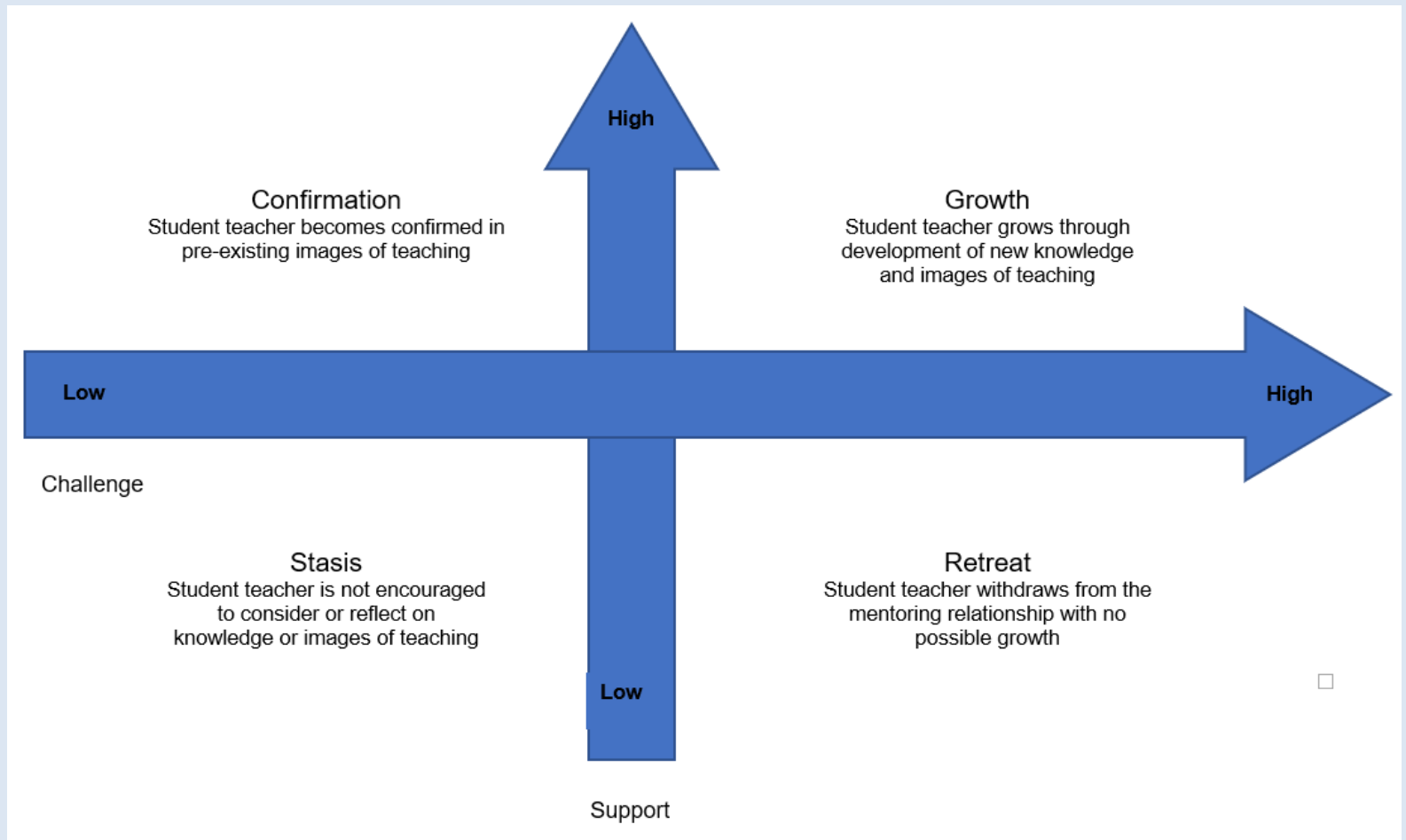
Crooks, V., London, L. and Snelson, H. (2021) ‘Singing from the same hymn-sheet’: Exploring school-based mentors’ perceptions of the role of HEI subject tutors in ITE partnerships’, *TEAN journal*, 13(1), pp.3-16.

SBM- school based mentor

UST – university subject tutors



Activity part 2

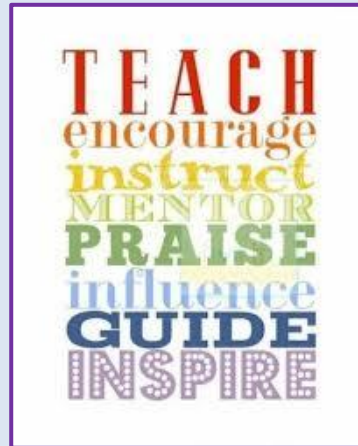


Summary

- the role of the mentor changes throughout the teaching placements as you gain in experience and independence
- he or she will step back from the processes of your assessment
- targets will still be set but these should be largely driven by you and what you want an observer to focus on
- when completing the assessment profile in the consolidation phase you should be showing your evidence to determine the grade to be awarded
- you should be driving this process – but always under the guidance and expertise of your mentor

Final thought ~

Your mentor
an expert colleague



supports,
challenges
and provides vision